

take Russia out of him. He ended his days as a US citizen, living in California, but his music remained true to the traditions he had absorbed in his youth. He was influenced by his homeland's folk songs and by the liturgical chants of the Russian Orthodox Church; and in his feeling for sweeping, soaring melody—often loaded with yearning and melancholy—he was the heir of Tchaikovsky, who encouraged and inspired him at the start of his career.



MUSIC CONSERVATORY, MOSCOW

In 1885, after failing his exams at the St. Petersburg Conservatory, Rachmaninoff transferred to the Moscow Conservatory of Music, where he thrived.

“ Rachmaninoff was made of steel and gold: steel in his arms, gold in his heart. ”

POLISH-AMERICAN PIANIST JOSEPH HOFMANN,
1945